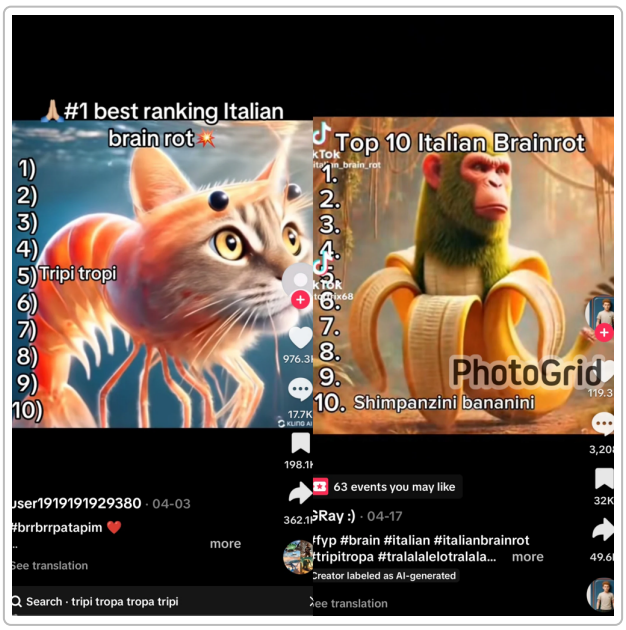
ChatGPT

# Viral Low-Effort Short-Form Content Formats (15–60 seconds)

## Absurdist "Brainrot" Meme Edits

One major trend in short videos is **"brainrot" memes** – intentionally absurd, chaotic clips that "rot your brain" with nonsense humor [1]. These typically feature **surreal AI-generated visuals** (often bizarre creature mashups) paired with **weird AI voiceovers** speaking gibberish or overdramatic lines. The appeal lies in content that's **so absurd and unpredictable that you can't stop watching** even as it fries your brain [1]. **Italian Brainrot** in particular went viral in 2025: creators make up characters with goofy pseudo-Italian names (e.g. *Bombardino Crocodilo*, *Shimpazini Bananannini*) and have an AI voice with an exaggerated Italian accent narrate dramatic nonsense [2] [3]. There are *no rules* – the more ridiculous, the better it performs [4]. These clips are very short (often 7–15 seconds [5]) and **low-effort to produce**: creators use AI image generators for the visuals, text-to-speech for the voice, slap on some overly emotional music, and add on-screen subtitles (often in "broken Italian" or random text) for comedic effect [6] [7]. If it **"feels stupid, you're doing it right,"** as one guide quips [8].




*Examples of popular brainrot meme characters that remix animals and objects with absurd AI visuals. Such bizarre, "cursed" creations (like* Tripi tropi *the cat/shrimp and* Shimpanzini bananini *the banana-ape) epitomize low-sense, high-engagement Gen-Z humor* [9].

**Viral examples:** One TikTok video featured a *"military crocodile" flying through the sky yelling in Italian ("Io sono la macchina del destino!")* – completely absurd, yet it racked up over 5 million views [10]. Another hit was a *shark wearing human sneakers spinning in slow motion* while an AI voice deadpans "Tralala… E BOOM," a nonsensical payoff that viewers found hilarious [11]. These brainrot videos thrive on **"how seriously unserious"** they are – they parody cliché tropes by exaggerating them to a point of surreal comedy [12]. Because the format is so remixable, many creators jump on the trend by making their own mini episodes of chaos: anyone can grab a meme character template, add a trending absurd sound (for

example the **"Tung Tung Tung Sahur"** chant that went viral during Ramadan 2025), and create a new iteration [13] [14]. The **low production effort** is part of the joke – visuals might be intentionally "messy" or low-fi, and editing is minimal (often a sudden cut at the end for comedic timing [7]). Despite (or because of) the nonsense, brainrot memes get **massive engagement** on TikTok and Shorts [15]. Tools like the Motionize app or simple mobile editors are commonly used to generate these memes quickly [16] [17], sometimes even with the help of ChatGPT to brainstorm the most "cursed" monologue lines [18]. In short, absurdist AI-driven edits have become a **fast-pass to virality** by embracing chaos and Gen Z's love of random, surreal humor.

## AI Narrated Skits and Storytime Videos

Another hugely popular format is the use of **AI text-to-speech (TTS) voices to narrate skits, stories, or dialogs**. Instead of appearing on camera or doing a voiceover themselves, creators simply feed a script into an AI voice generator and create a short comedic scene. A prominent example of this is the **"AI Presidents" meme**: viral videos imagine US presidents (and other public figures) bantering with each other in gaming or group chat scenarios [19] [20]. Clips on TikTok and YouTube Shorts have shown **Joe Biden, Barack Obama, Donald Trump, etc., having AI-generated conversations** full of gamer slang and outrageous remarks, which is hilarious precisely because it puts very familiar voices in absurd situations [19] [20]. For visuals, these skits often just use static images of the figures (or gameplay footage) with names on screen, while the AI-cloned voices carry the comedy [20]. Hearing, say, *an AI Obama say "It's your boy Joe Rizzler... try getting some bitches for once"* in a gaming context is both jarring and amusing, and such videos have garnered millions of views [21]. The **production workflow** is straightforward: creators script a funny exchange (sometimes even using ChatGPT to help write the dialogue), use a tool like ElevenLabs or TikTok's built-in voice effects to generate the voices, and pair it with minimal visuals (gameplay screen recordings, meme images, or subtitles). This **text-to-speech skit format** exploded in early 2023; as Business Insider noted, *"a new trend involving AI voices of celebrities and politicians is taking over TikTok,"* with countless clips of fake Biden, Trump, Joe Rogan, etc., doing things like playing **Minecraft or Among Us together** [19] [22].

*Screenshot from a viral AI voice skit, where cloned voices of public figures (e.g. Joe Rogan, President Biden) are overlaid on gameplay footage. Creators use static images and game clips while AI narrators deliver the humorous dialogue [20].*

Beyond famous figures, many everyday creators also use **AI narration for storytime or listicle content**. A common TikTok/Reels format is a short *story or rant read by the platform's built-in TTS voice*, often accompanied by subtitles and some background visuals. For example, someone might share a funny anecdote or **Reddit story** via on-screen text, and have the popular female TikTok TTS voice ("Jessie") read it aloud in a deadpan manner. This became so prevalent that TikTok's robotic voice has practically become a character of its own, narrating everything from **life hacks and shower thoughts to meme-y fictional scenarios**. The **auto-narration adds a comedic tone** – a monotone or overly-earnest inflection – that makes even mundane stories sound amusing. Brands have even jumped on this: e.g. Duolingo's TikTok account often uses the TTS voice for comedic effect while their owl mascot pantomimes in the background [23] [24]. The TTS feature is easy to apply in-app, so creators can churn out narrated mini-stories quickly. Many videos simply show the text being read (with auto-highlighting captions) and maybe a fitting image or silent video behind it. This is **low effort and high engagement** – it capitalizes on the fact that viewers can listen to a short story without the creator needing to perform on camera, and the on-screen text ensures even sound-off viewers are hooked. From *"AI-narrated Reddit tales"* (often coupled with oddly satisfying footage or Subway Surfers gameplay to maximize retention [25] [26]) to short **fictional skits written by AI** (e.g. "I asked ChatGPT to write a noir mystery and here's the result" narrated over noir images), text-to-speech storytelling is a staple of viral shorts. The combination of **clear captions, an expressive AI voice, and relatable or absurd content** is a proven recipe for high watch-time and shares.

## AI Voice Rants with Auto-Captions (Monologue Memes)

Closely related are the short **rant or monologue videos auto-narrated by AI voice**, often with dynamic captions for emphasis. In these, a creator will present a single-person comedic rant (e.g. a parody of an angry customer, a satirical "life advice" monologue, or an absurd personal confession) not by speaking it themselves, but by using an AI voice – which could be a **generic robot voice, a celebrity impression, or even a novelty character voice**. The content is typically a rapid-fire, humorous monologue, and the screen is filled with **big bold subtitles synchronizing with the speech**, sometimes with each word popping up in time (a style that grabs viewers' attention). Because the **voice is artificial**, these rants often have a flat or caricatured tone that paradoxically makes the delivery funnier. For example, someone might write a raging complaint about their day at school or a nonsense conspiracy theory, and have it spoken by the TikTok "male narrator" voice or a Spongebob-esque AI voice – the contrast between the outrageous content and the calm, automated delivery creates comedy. These videos require **minimal effort**: just typing the script and letting the app generate the speech and captions. TikTok and CapCut have auto-caption features that many use to ensure the text perfectly matches the audio. The result is a snappy 30-second rant where an AI voice is "yelling" about, say, *why pineapple on pizza is a government plot*, with on-screen text flying by. Viewers find this format engaging – it feels like reading a meme thread, but with the added humor of a synthetic narrator. Some creators take it further by using **AI voice filters** (TikTok occasionally offers fun TTS voices like a deep "Darth Vader" style or the Ghostface horror voice). During seasonal trends, we've seen monologues like *a Ghostface-voiced dark humor rant with horror movie captions* go viral for their novelty. There have also been instances of **deepfake-driven monologues**, where a creator uses an AI avatar or face swap to lip-sync the rant. For example, one could deepfake their face onto a celebrity and have the AI voice rant as if that celeb is delivering it – a form of *parody "speech"*. This crosses into deepfake comedy; a well-known case was the **"DeepTomCruise"** TikTok account, where a Tom Cruise lookalike (with an AI face filter) posted short clips of "Tom" giving casual quips. Those clips were so convincing they garnered tens of millions of views and even startled onlookers in Washington D.C. about the tech's implications [27] [28]. While that particular case was technically sophisticated, simpler versions (using available face-swap apps) are accessible to amateurs now. In summary, **auto-captioned AI voice monologues** let people vent or joke without showing their real self, producing content that is easy to consume (the bold

captions hook you) and easy to produce (no camera or mic needed). It's a format perfectly tailored to the short-form attention span.

## AI-Generated Visual Formats (Midjourney Slideshows & AI-Made Shorts)

2023–2025 also saw the rise of **AI-generated visuals + TTS + music** as a viral short-form format. In these, the *entire audiovisual content is machine-created or assisted*, often giving a surreal or striking result. A prime example is the wave of **"Balenciaga" AI parody videos**. The trend kicked off when a creator (username DemonFlyingFox) made a 55-second video *"Harry Potter by Balenciaga,"* which **went extremely viral** (millions of views within days) [29]. In this clip, iconic characters from Harry Potter were re-imagined as high-fashion models – **AI-generated images** gave characters like Hagrid, Snape, and Harry exaggerated cheekbones, couture outfits, and runway poses [30] [31]. An AI *voice clone* of Snape delivered meme-worthy lines (e.g. *"What is the difference, Potter, between H&M and Balenciaga?"*) over a **pulsing electronic music track**, creating a perfect absurd mashup [32] [33]. Remarkably, this cinematic-feeling parody was made with minimal resources: the creator used **Midjourney (for images), ElevenLabs (for voices), and D-ID (to animate faces)**, completing the whole video in a couple of days [34]. As a *Futurism* report noted, *"you just created a $2 million ad for probably less than 10 bucks,"* highlighting how low-cost these AI tools make such productions [35]. The virality of "Harry Potter Balenciaga" spawned many imitators and spin-offs – soon there were short AI-generated trailers for *Lord of the Rings by Balenciaga, Star Wars by Balenciaga,* and beyond [36] [37]. There was even a trend of **"Wes Anderson style" AI shorts**, like imagining *Lord of the Rings as directed by Wes Anderson*, using the same principle of AI art + TTS narration. These formats show how **AI allows rapid creation of visually intense, shareable shorts** that tap into pop culture.

*Frame from the viral "Harry Potter by Balenciaga" AI video. Using Midjourney, characters like Harry Potter were re-envisioned as high-fashion models with chiseled features and designer attire. This 55-second AI-generated spoof spread rapidly across platforms* [32] [38].

Another AI visual format is the **slideshow or music video of AI images**. For instance, creators might prompt Midjourney or Stable Diffusion for a series of images (e.g. "imagine the year 2090 in cyberpunk style" or a sequence of an original story) and then compile the images into a 30-second slideshow, with

a text-to-speech voice or simply music to tie it together. One popular approach is *AI-generated horror or sci-fi shorts*: the creator generates eerie art frames and uses a spooky TTS narration to tell a micro-story. These often thrive on YouTube Shorts and TikTok's slideshow feature, as they deliver a quick narrative entirely through AI visuals and narration. The **workflow** typically involves using an AI text generator (ChatGPT) to write a tiny story or script, an image generator to produce illustrations for each line or scene, and an AI voice to narrate, then stitching them with automated timing. It's now possible to do all this with one-stop tools (e.g. Runway's Gen-2 can make short videos from prompts, and apps like **Filmora's AI Image-to-Video** let users generate a meme video from an image with a single click [39] [40]). The result isn't Hollywood-level, but it's engagingly novel and **easy content for one person to create**. For example, a TikTok trend involved people posting **AI portraits of themselves (from apps like Lensa) set to music** – effectively letting an AI "paint" multiple versions of you and turning it into a quick reel. Another instance: the viral **"Pope in a puffer jacket" AI image** led to short videos sharing a collection of such AI-generated fashion images with commentary, which blurred reality for many viewers [41]. All these formats leverage the "wow" factor of generative AI visuals – they catch eyes in the feed – combined with minimal human production (no filming needed, just curation of AI outputs). As one journalist observed, we've reached the point where *"anyone can spend a few days or hours experimenting with AI and create something like Balenciaga Harry Potter"* [34]. The ease and virality of these formats suggest a new creative paradigm where **AI art + short-form video** yields endless quirky content.

## Gen Z Surreal Humor and Low-Effort "Zoomer" Edits

Many viral short videos aren't explicitly labeled as AI creations, but they embody **Gen Z's absurdist, low-effort humor** – often produced with quick editing or basic tools – which sometimes overlaps with AI elements. These are the **"shitpost" style edits** that dominate TikTok meme culture. Hallmarks of this genre include **random juxtapositions, "deep-fried" video effects, distorted audio, and layers of inside jokes or slang**. Crucially, the aesthetic is *deliberately* low-quality or chaotic, which makes it feel authentic and funny to young audiences. For example, a typical absurd edit might rapidly splice together a Spongebob clip, a Vine boom sound effect, an "Ohio meme" reference, and on-screen text saying something grammatically jumbled – all in 20 seconds with no clear logic. As one commentator decoded, *"random absurdity is characteristic of zoomer humor. They are often distorted to purposely look low effort, and are quite popular"* [42]. This means creators don't need fancy equipment or hours of editing – intentionally **slapping together nonsense** in CapCut (often using trending meme templates) can yield a viral hit if it resonates with the current ironic trend.

Some of these trends do use AI-generated components as part of the joke. For instance, it's become common to see **AI-generated images or art inserted in surreal memes** (for that extra "cursed" vibe). Meme pages have shared things like weird DALL·E mini creations (e.g. a blurry "Batman in Teletubbyland" image) as punchlines. Even brands have tried to tap this: anecdotally, political campaign TikToks in New Zealand were caught using "low-effort AI-generated art" in meme posts to appear trendy to Gen Z [43]. This demonstrates how *"low effort"* has become an aesthetic itself – sometimes using AI as a quick content factory to produce goofy visuals that a creator can then incorporate with minimal editing. **Gen Z surrealism** also manifests in trends like **"Corecore" or meme montages**, where seemingly unrelated video clips or images are thrown together with emotional music to evoke a feeling. These often require little more than downloading a few clips and adding a song, but they strike a chord through absurd juxtaposition. For example, the **"Grimace Shake" trend** (where people pretended a McDonald's purple shake caused horror-movie scenarios) had a very lo-fi execution: shaky phone footage and dollar-store props – yet it went hugely viral for its absurdity. While not AI-driven, it underscores the point that **low production quality can be a feature, not a bug**, when aiming for Gen Z engagement.

Another aspect is **"parasocial mimicry"** – content that imitates real personalities or social scenarios in a tongue-in-cheek way, often using AI. We've touched on deepfake celebrity skits and AI voices of presidents; those are parasocial in that they let viewers feel like they're eavesdropping on famous figures. But even on a smaller scale, creators use tools to mimic the *format* of personal content. For example, some TikTokers create fake **"POV: Facetime call" videos** where they use a filter or pre-recorded video to simulate a friend or celebrity calling the viewer. A few have used **AI avatars** to play the role of a virtual friend or partner in such skits, capitalizing on the parasocial pull (viewers tagging their friends saying "why did I actually feel comforted by this?"). There are also AI chatbot characters (like **Kuki AI**) that have social media accounts; while not huge yet, they post short videos interacting with commenters, essentially acting as virtual influencers. All of this blurs the line between real and simulated social interaction. It's low-effort in the sense that a creator might rely on an AI persona to generate content (the AI responds to fans, tells stories, etc., with the human just facilitating). As AI voice cloning and avatar tech become more accessible, we see more **"mimicry" content – people puppeteering an AI copy of someone** for entertainment. A cautionary example was the deepfake **Tom Cruise** account: one person's clever use of face-swapping and impersonation created a series of TikTok clips so realistic that they amassed over 10 million views and spooked even security experts [27] [28]. While that involved skill, simpler *Snapchat face swap* filters can let anyone pretend to be, say, a famous rapper delivering a silly message for a quick video. These mimicry formats go viral because they exploit our existing parasocial bonds (we're drawn to familiar faces/voices) and do so often in a humorous, low-budget way – essentially *fan-fiction in video form*.

## AI Avatars, Filters, and ChatGPT-Style Trends

Finally, short-form platforms have been inundated with **AI-powered filters and avatar effects**, which themselves became viral formats. A prime example is TikTok's **"Bold Glamour" filter** (an AI-driven beauty filter) which went viral in 2023. Millions of users posted 15-second videos applying Bold Glamour to their face in real-time, marveling at the nearly flawless, airbrushed look it gave [44]. No editing or shooting skill was needed – people simply recorded reactions to the filter. The *format* was just *"look how crazy this AI filter is!"*, and that was engaging content in itself. Similarly, TikTok's **AI Manga filter** (which turns you into an anime character) spawned a trend of quick videos where users would try it on themselves, their pets, or even celebrities on a screen, and show the often-funny results. Each such video is low effort (one tap to apply filter) but high reward, as viewers love transformations. These filter trends demonstrate how **augmented reality AI effects** can generate viral short content that's easily replicable by anyone.

Another popular avenue is **AI avatar lip-syncs**. Apps like Wombo and Reface (and more advanced ones like **D-ID**) let you take a single image and animate it to speak or sing. This led to memes like *photos of random historical figures singing pop songs*, which circulated as short clips. For instance, a viral reel might show an AI-animated Mona Lisa belting a Beyoncé chorus – pure absurd, shareable humor achieved with one click in an app. Likewise, some creators use **Synthesia or similar AI avatar video generators** to create a virtual character who delivers a short message or joke. This has been used for pranks (e.g. making a photo of your boss "say" a funny announcement) and for content like AI news parodies (an avatar presenter giving a fake news update). The key is that **AI avatars can perform on your behalf**, so content can be generated with virtually no traditional production – just input text and choose an avatar.

Lastly, **ChatGPT-style storytelling** has found its way into short videos. Creative users leverage ChatGPT or other AI writers to generate humorous or whimsical content, then package it into a Reel/TikTok. For example, a trend on Reels was *"I asked ChatGPT to write a poem about my cat, and then I put it to music"* – the video would show the poem (often adorably corny) via captions or an AI voice, over a montage of cat pictures. Another instance: using ChatGPT to simulate *odd scenarios* ("ChatGPT, write a Tinder bio in the voice of Shrek"), then presenting the funniest outputs as a series of text bubbles in a 30-second

video. Some TikTokers also do skits where the *script is entirely AI-generated*: they read (or have an AI voice read) a short script that ChatGPT wrote for them – often marked by the peculiar, overly literal style that the AI has, which audiences find amusing. In effect, the creator acts as a curator of ChatGPT's content. There's also a meta trend of **documenting AI conversations**: e.g. screen-recording a humorous back-and-forth with an AI (like Character.AI or ChatGPT's alter egos) and sharing highlights as a short video. This turns the **process of interacting with AI into shareable content**. It's minimal effort because the entertainment comes from the AI's responses, not the user's performance.

In summary, the landscape of viral short-form videos is now filled with **formats that are easily replicable through AI tools or very simple editing**. From **brainrotting absurd memes** born of text-to-image generators, to **text-to-speech comedy skits**, **auto-captioned rants**, **AI-crafted visuals with voiceover**, and the general **lo-fi chaotic edits loved by Gen Z**, these trends show that **content creation barriers are lower than ever**. Anyone with a wild idea can plug it into an AI tool and create a 30-second clip that might catch fire online. The common thread is **low production cost, high creativity/novelty, and reliance on algorithms (AI or platform algorithms) to amplify the content.** By leveraging AI for voices, images, and editing, creators can produce engaging Shorts/Reels in minutes. And by tapping into the absurd, the relatable, or the nostalgically familiar (even via deepfakes), they trigger the massive engagement that makes things go viral. It's an era where a **voice clone argument between Presidents, or a gibberish-speaking AI crocodile, or a one-click beauty filter reaction** can dominate the feed – truly highlighting how short-form storytelling has evolved with the rise of AI and the meme-hungry humor of the younger generation.

**Sources:** Connected throughout the text as inline citations [1] [20], etc. Each citation corresponds to an external source that substantiates the preceding claim or example.

---


[1] [2] [4] [9] [12] [13] [14] [39] [40] How Italian Brainrot Memes Took Over TikTok
https://filmora.wondershare.com/image-to-video/italian-brainrot-meme.html

[3] [5] [6] [7] [8] [10] [11] [15] [16] [17] [18] How to Make Viral Brainrot Memes | The Ultimate 2025 Guide
https://motionize.ai/blog/how-to-make-your-own-brainrot-meme-and-go-viral

[19] [20] [21] [22] AI Voices of Politicians and Influencers Are Taking Over TikTok - Business Insider
https://www.businessinsider.com/ai-voices-of-politicians-and-influencers-are-taking-over-tiktok-2023-2

[23] [24] How to Do Text-to-Speech on TikTok (+ 10 World-Class Examples)
https://influencermarketinghub.com/text-to-speech-on-tiktok/

[25] [26] What's the deal with videos being played beside soap-cutting videos and Subway Surfers gameplay? : r/OutOfTheLoop
https://www.reddit.com/r/OutOfTheLoop/comments/10kb11f/whats_the_deal_with_videos_being_played_beside/

[27] [28] The Tom Cruise deepfake that set off 'terror' in the heart of Washington DC - ABC News
https://www.abc.net.au/news/2021-06-24/tom-cruise-deepfake-chris-ume-security-washington-dc/100234772

[29] [36] [37] Balenciaga AI Videos Ranked From Worst to Believable
https://www.highsnobiety.com/p/balenciaga-ai-videos/

[30] The biggest threat AI poses? A Harry Potter remake set in Balenciaga-land | Dazed
https://www.dazeddigital.com/fashion/article/58532/1/balenciaga-harry-potter-ai-video-viral-demna-snape-emma-watson-demonflyingfox

[31] [32] [33] [35] [38] Perplexing AI Video Turns "Harry Potter" Into Balenciaga Ad
https://futurism.com/the-byte/ai-harry-potter-balenciaga

34 41 AI-generated video like “Balenciaga Harry Potter” could be the future of entertainment | Vox
https://www.vox.com/culture/23678708/ai-art-balenciaga-harry-potter-midjourney-eleven-labs

42 Zoomer Memes and the Lost Generation | by Anthony | Medium
https://medium.com/@phonksidaron/humor-is-a-window-into-the-soul-71b466893ef8

43 national is using low effort ai generated art for their stoner memes on ...
https://www.reddit.com/r/newzealand/comments/1f65y6f/national_is_using_low_effort_ai_generated_art_for/

44 TikTok Bold Glamour Filter — Unrealistic Reality and Risks - Banuba
https://www.banuba.com/blog/tiktok-bold-glamour-filter-unrealistic-reality-and-risks